

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Lantern Road is a 2018 novel by Hana Yusuf. In the novel, the narrator describes her uncle, Mr. Karim, as someone who expresses affection through practical acts rather than words: _____ Which quotation from The Lantern Road most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Mr. Karim kept the house in perfect order -- he repaired the shutters each spring, oiled the hinges before they could squeak, and restocked the pantry every Sunday with the same efficient routine he brought to his work at the shop.'

B: 'When his niece was upset, Mr. Karim would sit beside her and tell her stories about her mother until the girl calmed down, his voice softening with each detail he chose to share.'

C: 'Mr. Karim rarely said "I love you," but every morning he polished his niece's shoes until they shone and left them by the door before she woke.'

D: 'Mr. Karim would spend hours in conversation with his niece, asking about her friends, laughing at her jokes, and offering advice on her homework with a patience that surprised even himself.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says 'practical acts rather than words.' C shows a practical act (polishing shoes) explicitly framed as replacing verbal affection ('rarely said I love you, but...'). A shows practical skill but general maintenance, not directed affection. B and D both show affection through words -- telling stories, conversation, advising.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Below the Ridgeline is a 2020 novel by Samuel Adeyemi. The narrator portrays the town of Millhaven as a place where residents resist change: _____ Which quotation from Below the Ridgeline most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'When the county proposed paving the old dirt road, the town council voted it down, arguing that the road had served them fine for a hundred years and would serve them fine for a hundred more.'

B: 'Millhaven's oldest residents remembered when the town had no electricity, and they often reminisced about those simpler days over coffee at the general store.'

C: 'The Millhaven Historical Society held a fundraiser every spring, using the proceeds to restore the town's century-old courthouse to its original condition.'

D: 'Every autumn, the residents of Millhaven gathered at the town square for the harvest festival, a tradition that had continued unbroken for seventy-five years.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'resist change' requires active opposition to something new. A shows the council voting DOWN a proposal -- that is resistance. B shows nostalgia (remembering the past), not opposing a new proposal. C shows preservation of a historic building, which is voluntary restoration, not resistance. D shows a long-running tradition, which is continuation, not opposition to anything.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Copper and Sage is a 2017 novel by Eloise Marchetti. The narrator describes her grandmother as someone who treated cooking as a form of storytelling: _____ Which quotation from Copper and Sage most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Grandmother approached her kitchen with the same discipline she brought to everything else, timing each step with a clock and adjusting seasonings until the flavor met her exacting standards.'

B: 'Each dish Grandmother prepared carried a narrative -- the lamb stew was her mother's recipe from the old country, the honey cake commemorated the year the bees returned to the orchard, and the bread was kneaded in a rhythm she said matched the heartbeat of the village.'

C: 'Grandmother spent hours teaching her grandchildren to cook, guiding their hands as they chopped vegetables and explaining the importance of each technique she had learned over the decades.'

D: 'Grandmother's meals brought the family together, and it was at her table that disputes were settled, plans were made, and news was shared among three generations.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says 'cooking as a form of storytelling,' so the quotation must show dishes carrying narratives. B names three dishes with three stories behind them. A shows cooking as precision (discipline, timing). C shows cooking as teaching (guiding hands, explaining technique). D shows meals as community-building (table where things are discussed), not the cooking itself as narrative.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Glass Pier is a 2019 novel by Tomas Rivera-Santos. The text presents a contrast between the protagonist, Elena, and her sister, Luz, suggesting that Elena is cautious while Luz is impulsive: _____ Which quotation from The Glass Pier most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Elena spent the afternoon studying the tide charts before wading into the shallows, while Luz sat on the pier reading quietly, her feet dangling above the water she never quite touched.'

B: 'Elena and Luz approached the market together, each drawn to different stalls, but both sisters examined every item carefully, weighing each purchase before reaching for their wallets.'

C: 'Elena envied her sister's confidence and often wished she could make decisions as firmly and deliberately as Luz did, without the hours of second-guessing that kept Elena up at night.'

D: 'Elena would study a menu for twenty minutes before ordering the same dish she always had; Luz would close her eyes, point, and declare whatever her finger landed on to be destiny.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: a contrast claim needs BOTH sides illustrated. D shows Elena cautious (studying the menu, ordering the same thing) AND Luz impulsive (pointing randomly). A shows Elena cautious but Luz passive/careful -- not impulsive. B shows both sisters being careful -- no impulsiveness at all. C calls Luz 'firm and deliberate,' which is confidence, not impulsiveness.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Night Freight is a 2021 novel by Kwame Asare. The narrator describes the old train station as a place that inspires a sense of abandonment: _____ Which quotation from Night Freight most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Weeds pushed through the cracked tiles of the platform, and the ticket booth's glass was so thick with dust that the schedule behind it had become unreadable.'

B: 'The station's architecture was remarkable -- arched ceilings, wrought-iron benches, and a clock tower that still kept perfect time after ninety years of service.'

C: 'The platform was empty at that hour, and the silence was broken only by the distant rumble of a freight train passing through on its way to the coast.'

D: 'The old station had been converted into a community center where local artists displayed their work and musicians performed on Saturday evenings.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'abandonment' means left behind permanently, so look for signs of decay and disuse. A shows weeds, cracked tiles, and dust-covered glass -- permanent neglect. B shows the station in good condition (clock still works) -- the opposite. C shows temporary emptiness ('at that hour') with a train still passing -- not abandoned. D shows the station repurposed and active -- the opposite of abandoned.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Mapmaker's Daughter is a 2016 novel by Rina Chatterjee. The text describes the character Devika as possessing an exceptional memory: _____ Which quotation from The Mapmaker's Daughter most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Devika was the fastest reader in her department, finishing reports in half the time it took her colleagues and summarizing complex documents with remarkable clarity.'

B: 'Devika kept a meticulously organized filing system and labeled every folder, drawer, and shelf in her office so that she could locate any document within seconds.'

C: 'Devika noticed details that others missed -- the slight change in a colleague's tone, the misplaced decimal in a budget report, the crack forming in the office ceiling.'

D: 'Devika could recite the name of every student who had sat beside her in school, the color of their notebooks, and the order in which the teacher had called roll on the first day of every term.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'exceptional memory' means recalling past details, not performing well in the present. D shows recall of specific past details (names, colors, roll-call order from school). A shows reading speed and comprehension -- a cognitive skill, not memory. B shows organizational systems -- she uses tools to find things, which actually avoids relying on memory. C shows sharp observation in real time, not recall of past events.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Watershed is a 2022 novel by Ingrid Solheim. In the novel, the narrator suggests that the character Henrik uses humor as a shield to avoid discussing his emotions: _____ Which quotation from Watershed most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Henrik's jokes were legendary at the office, and he often stayed late to entertain colleagues with impressions of their manager, drawing laughs that could be heard down the hallway.'

B: 'Whenever someone asked Henrik how he was really feeling, he would grin and answer with a punchline -- "Fantastic, like a house on fire," he once said, the week his divorce was finalized.'

C: 'Henrik's sense of humor was gentle and self-deprecating, and his friends appreciated that he could laugh at his own mistakes without ever taking himself too seriously.'

D: 'Henrik rarely laughed and found most jokes juvenile, preferring instead the company of people who could hold a serious conversation about things that mattered.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'humor as a shield' means humor deployed SPECIFICALLY to deflect emotional probing. B shows Henrik cracking a joke exactly when someone asks about his real feelings, during a painful time (divorce). A shows humor as social entertainment at work -- no emotional avoidance. C shows humor as comfortable self-deprecation -- openness, not deflection. D contradicts the claim entirely (Henrik avoids humor, not emotions).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Salt and Iron is a 2019 novel by Chibuzo Eze. The narrator characterizes the village elder, Nneka, as someone whose authority derives not from her title but from the community's trust in her judgment: _____ Which quotation from Salt and Iron most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Nneka had been elected by the largest margin in village history, and her supporters cited her decades of public service as the reason they had cast their votes in her favor.'

B: 'When Nneka entered a room, voices fell silent and eyes turned to her, drawn by a commanding presence that seemed to belong to her nature rather than to any position she held.'

C: 'Nneka enforced the village code with firm consistency, and residents complied because they understood that penalties for disobedience would be swift and unavoidable.'

D: 'The villagers obeyed Nneka not because she could compel them -- she had no power to punish -- but because her counsel had never steered them wrong, and they had come to regard her word as more reliable than any written law.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim has two parts -- authority NOT from title, but FROM trust. D matches both: 'no power to punish' (not from title) and 'counsel had never steered them wrong' (trust in judgment). A shows authority from an election (a formal process, tied to title). B shows authority from personal charisma/presence -- innate, not earned through judgment. C shows authority through enforcement and penalties -- that is power from position, the opposite.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Understory is a 2021 novel by Nikolai Avenov. The narrator suggests that the protagonist, Dr. Linden, views scientific fieldwork as an almost spiritual practice: _____ Which quotation from The Understory most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Dr. Linden was ruthlessly efficient in the field, completing each survey in half the allotted time so that she could return to the laboratory, where she felt the real science happened.'

B: 'Dr. Linden approached every field season with the same careful planning: permits filed months in advance, equipment inventoried, and research assistants briefed on protocols down to the smallest detail.'

C: 'For Dr. Linden, kneeling in the moss to count seedlings was not labor but a kind of prayer -- each data point an offering to a truth larger than herself.'

D: 'Dr. Linden found that the physical demands of fieldwork -- the long hikes, the cold mornings, the unpredictable weather -- kept her grounded in a way that desk work never could.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'almost spiritual' means the quotation must use language associated with reverence, ritual, or transcendence. C uses 'prayer,' 'offering,' and 'truth larger than herself' -- unmistakably spiritual language. A shows efficiency and preference for the lab -- the opposite of reverence for fieldwork. B shows thorough planning, which is professional, not spiritual. D shows fieldwork as physically grounding -- meaningful but not spiritual.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Borrowed Year is a 2020 novel by Fatima Al-Rashid. The text presents the narrator's father as someone who believed that education was the only reliable form of wealth: _____ Which quotation from The Borrowed Year most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: '"They can take your house and your land," my father would say, tapping his temple, "but they cannot repossess what is in here."'

B: 'My father insisted that all of his children attend university, not because he valued learning for its own sake but because he believed a degree was the surest path to a well-paying career.'

C: 'My father spent every evening reading to us, choosing books that he said would open doors we did not yet know existed and teach us to think for ourselves.'

D: 'My father urged his children to study hard, reminding them that without discipline, even the most gifted student would fall behind those willing to put in longer hours.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says education IS wealth -- the most reliable kind. A directly compares education to property (house, land) and says education cannot be taken away -- framing it AS wealth. B shows education as a path to a career (instrumental, not wealth itself). C shows education as opening doors (opportunity, not wealth). D stresses discipline and effort in education, not the idea that education is a form of wealth.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Harbour Lights is a 2018 novel by Delia Caron. The narrator describes the seaside town of Brixton Cove as a place whose economy depends entirely on the unpredictable rhythms of the fishing season: _____ Which quotation from Harbour Lights most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Brixton Cove's harbor was the heart of the town, and even residents who had never set foot on a boat felt a kinship with the sea that defined their daily rhythms.'

B: 'The fishermen of Brixton Cove were respected figures in the community, their knowledge of the waters passed down through generations and their opinions sought on everything from town budgets to school curricula.'

C: 'Every autumn, the town held a festival to celebrate the end of the fishing season, with music, competitions, and a market where the day's catch was sold alongside local crafts and baked goods.'

D: 'In good years, when the catch was abundant, the town hummed with prosperity -- new boats were ordered, debts were paid, and the pub stayed open past midnight. In lean years, the same town went quiet, its docks empty, its storefronts dark.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'economy depends entirely' means the whole town's fortune rises and falls with the catch. D shows exactly this contrast -- prosperity in good years, shutdown in lean years, affecting boats, debts, storefronts. A shows cultural identity tied to the sea, not economic dependence. B shows social respect for fishermen, not that the economy depends on fishing. C shows a festival alongside crafts and baked goods -- suggesting the economy is NOT entirely fishing-dependent.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Northern Meridian is a 2017 novel by Ingrid Solheim. The narrator suggests that the lighthouse keeper, Astrid, finds human conversation exhausting in a way that solitude is not: _____. Which quotation from Northern Meridian most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Astrid cherished her evening conversations with the supply-boat captain, their weekly exchanges about weather and tides being the one social ritual she looked forward to in her routine.'

B: 'After an hour with visitors, Astrid felt as though she had run a marathon, her mind aching from the effort of following their words; alone with the sea, she could sit for a full day without fatigue.'

C: 'Astrid preferred the company of the lighthouse cat to human visitors, not because she disliked people but because the cat demanded nothing from her except warmth and the occasional meal.'

D: 'Astrid had grown so accustomed to the sound of the waves that any human voice, no matter how friendly, struck her as an intrusion on the rhythm she had come to depend on.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim names a specific contrast -- conversation IS exhausting, solitude IS NOT. B provides both sides: an hour with visitors = 'run a marathon' (exhausting), alone with the sea = 'full day without fatigue' (not). A contradicts the claim (she looks forward to conversation). C shows preferring the cat for low demands -- that is about demand level, not about conversation being exhausting. D shows voices as an intrusion on her routine -- that is about disruption, not about exhaustion specifically.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Quiet Republic is a 2015 novel by Omar Bello. The text suggests that the character Augusto has come to see silence not as consent but as a survival strategy: _____. Which quotation from The Quiet Republic most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Augusto believed that the people around him were silent simply because they had no interest in politics and preferred to focus on their daily routines rather than on public affairs.'

B: 'Augusto had learned to choose his words with care, speaking only when he was confident that his opinion would be well received by those who held authority over his livelihood.'

C: '"We do not hold our tongues because we have nothing to say," Augusto told his son. "We hold them because the price of speech is one we cannot afford to pay."'

D: 'Augusto admired those who spoke out against the government, but he himself remained silent because he found public debate pointless and exhausting rather than dangerous.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says silence is 'not consent but a survival strategy.' C addresses both parts: 'not because we have nothing to say' (not consent) and 'the price of speech is one we cannot afford' (survival). A frames silence as indifference (no interest in politics), not survival. B shows strategic speech (he does speak, just carefully) -- not silence as a strategy. D says he finds debate 'pointless and exhausting rather than dangerous' -- cynicism, not survival.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Cartographer's Silence is a 2020 novel by Anwar Haddad. The narrator suggests that the protagonist views his maps of endangered landscapes as acts of defiance against the forces that threaten those landscapes: _____ Which quotation from The Cartographer's Silence most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Each contour line he traced was a refusal -- a declaration that the marsh, the grove, the meadow had existed and that no developer's bulldozer could erase a thing already recorded.'

B: 'He mapped the endangered landscapes with the meticulous care of someone who understood that accuracy was essential for the conservation agencies that would rely on his data to build their case.'

C: 'He spent years mapping remote landscapes that few had ever visited, driven by a curiosity about places that existed at the edges of the known world and might vanish before anyone else recorded them.'

D: 'His maps were treasured by collectors for their beauty, each one a work of art that captured the mood of a landscape as faithfully as its geography.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'defiance' means the maps are framed as opposition -- an act of resistance. A uses 'refusal' and 'declaration' and names the opposing force ('developer's bulldozer') -- that is defiance. B shows maps serving conservation agencies -- practical utility, not personal defiance. C shows mapping driven by curiosity about remote places, not opposition to anything. D shows maps valued as art -- aesthetic quality, not a stance of resistance.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Bridge of Reeds is a 2019 novel by Daniel Okwu. The narrator portrays Elder Nkechi as someone whose wisdom lies not in offering solutions but in asking questions that force others to reconsider their assumptions: _____ Which quotation from Bridge of Reeds most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'When the village faced a dispute, Nkechi would listen to both sides and then deliver her verdict with such calm authority that no one dared challenge the decision she had reached.'

B: 'Nkechi gathered the village elders each month and shared the lessons she had learned from her own mistakes, believing that her experience could spare the younger generation from repeating the same errors.'

C: 'Nkechi was known for her patience, allowing debates to continue for hours before stepping in with a compromise that satisfied both parties and put the matter to rest.'

D: 'When the young farmers demanded a new irrigation canal, Nkechi did not say yes or no. Instead she asked, "What happened to the last canal we built?" and the room fell silent, for they all knew it had dried up within a decade.'

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says wisdom lies in 'asking questions,' not 'offering solutions.' D shows Nkechi refusing to give a yes or no and instead posing a question that silences the room -- forcing reconsideration. A shows her delivering a verdict (a solution). B shows her sharing lessons (giving answers from experience). C shows her offering compromise (another form of solution).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Tidal Ledger is a 2022 poetry collection by Yuki Tanabe. The speaker uses the image of tides to suggest that loss is not a single event but an ongoing process of gradual erosion: _____ Which quotation from Tidal Ledger most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'The storm struck without warning, and by morning the shoreline she had known was gone -- every familiar stone and dune swept away in a single violent night.'

B: 'She stood at the cliff's edge and watched a single wave crash against the rocks below, marveling at the force with which it struck and wondering how anything could survive such power.'

C: 'It was not the wave that took the shore / but the tide's long habit of return, / each visit carrying a little more / of what I thought was mine to keep.'

D: 'The sea rose and fell beside her like a breathing companion, constant and familiar, and she felt neither fear nor grief in its presence -- only the quiet comfort of something that would outlast her.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says loss is 'not a single event but an ongoing process of gradual erosion.' C uses 'not the wave' (not a single event) and 'the tide's long habit of return, each visit carrying a little more' (ongoing, gradual). A shows sudden, violent loss in one night -- the opposite. B shows awe at a single wave's force -- single event. D shows the sea as a comforting companion -- no loss at all.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Season of Dust is a 2019 novel by Lena Okafor. The narrator characterizes Amara's grandmother as someone who communicates disapproval not through words but through deliberate, pointed silence: _____ Which quotation from Season of Dust most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'Her grandmother shook her head slowly and murmured, "You will regret this," in a tone so quiet that Amara had to lean forward to catch the words -- but once heard, they could not be unheard.'

B: 'When Amara announced she was leaving the village, her grandmother said nothing. She simply set down her teacup with exaggerated care, folded her hands, and looked out the window as though Amara had not spoken at all -- a silence so deliberate it was louder than any rebuke.'

C: 'Her grandmother wrote Amara a letter that evening, three pages of carefully chosen words expressing her disappointment and outlining every reason the decision was a mistake.'

D: 'Her grandmother called a family meeting and, in front of everyone, listed the sacrifices she had made for Amara's education, asking how the girl could repay her generosity with such ingratitude.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: 'not through words but through deliberate silence' -- the correct quotation must show the grandmother NOT speaking. B says 'said nothing' and describes deliberate physical actions (setting down teacup, folding hands, looking away). A shows quiet verbal disapproval -- she does murmur words ('You will regret this'). C shows written disapproval -- words on paper are still words. D shows loud public verbal confrontation -- the most word-heavy option.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Unfinished Garden is a 2022 novel by Rosa Figuroa. The text suggests that the architect, Valentina, believes the value of creative work lies in the process of making it, not in whether it is ever used: _____ Which quotation from The Unfinished Garden most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "A drawing that solves a problem is a drawing that matters," Valentina told her apprentice, "even if the building is never built. The thinking is the thing -- the rest is just weather."

B: 'Valentina kept every sketch she had ever made, not out of sentimentality but because each one represented a step in her development as an architect -- a record of problems she had learned to solve over decades.'

C: 'Valentina poured her full energy into every commission, driven by the belief that a completed building was the ultimate proof of an architect's worth and the only legacy that would outlast her.'

D: 'Valentina spent months refining each design, revising and adjusting until she was satisfied, because she knew that her reputation depended on the quality of the buildings that carried her name.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says value lies 'in the process, not in whether it is ever used.' A says the drawing matters 'even if the building is never built' and 'the thinking is the thing' -- value in process regardless of use. B values sketches as a growth record -- about personal development, not the process itself. C says completed buildings are the ultimate proof of worth -- value in the product. D ties quality to reputation -- value in the finished result, not the process.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Borrowed Light is a 2018 essay collection by Saoirse Brennan. The speaker suggests that memory does not preserve the past faithfully but instead reshapes it to reflect what the rememberer needs in the present: _____. Which quotation from Borrowed Light most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'I have forgotten almost everything about that year -- only a handful of images remain, scattered and disconnected, like photographs pulled from a water-damaged album.'

B: 'My brother and I argued endlessly about what had really happened that summer, each of us certain that our version was correct and the other's was pure invention.'

C: 'The kitchen I remember is not the kitchen that existed. I have rearranged the furniture, softened the light, removed the argument from the table and replaced it with laughter, because that is the kitchen I need to have come from.'

D: 'I keep a box of letters from that period, and every time I reread them I am startled by how different the events were from the way I remember them -- proof that my recollections have been unreliable all along.'

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says memory 'reshapes' the past 'to reflect what the rememberer needs.' C names specific reshaping acts (rearranged furniture, softened light, replaced argument with laughter) and gives the reason: 'because that is the kitchen I need to have come from.' A shows memory fading (forgetting), not reshaping. B shows two people disagreeing about the past -- conflicting accounts, not purposeful reshaping. D shows discovering that memory is inaccurate via evidence, not actively reshaping to serve a need.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Quotation Illustrates Claim

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Thread and the Needle is a 2021 novel by Elif Bozkurt. The narrator suggests that the tailor sees his craft as a way of imposing order on the chaos of human life, with each garment representing a small act of control: _____ Which quotation from The Thread and the Needle most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: 'The tailor worked in silence, his hands moving with a speed and precision born of forty years at the same bench, producing garments that were technically flawless but, he admitted, devoid of any personal signature.'

B: '"People come to me in disarray," the tailor said, pressing a lapel flat with his iron. "Their marriages are failing, their children are ungrateful, their businesses are collapsing. I cannot fix any of that. But I can make a seam that is straight, a hem that is even, a collar that lies flat. And for the hour they wear my coat, the world fits."'

C: 'The tailor took pride in his ability to make clients feel confident, believing that a well-fitted suit could transform a person's posture, bearing, and self-perception in ways that no amount of advice ever could.'

D: 'The tailor refused to rush any order, no matter how urgent the deadline, insisting that every stitch receive the same care whether the garment was meant for a wedding or a funeral, because fabric, he said, does not know the occasion.'

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Shortcut: the claim says the tailor's craft 'imposes order on the chaos of human life.' B names the chaos (failing marriages, ungrateful children, collapsing businesses) and the order (straight seam, even hem, flat collar) and connects them: 'the world fits.' A shows technical mastery but no philosophy about order and chaos. C shows garments boosting confidence -- about self-perception, not imposing order on life's disorder. D shows equal care for all occasions -- about professional standards, not the order-versus-chaos theme.

END QUESTION